

CANONICAL LESSON

One Service Picture, Three Different Systems

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

Production Unit	PU-B07-C55
Notebook	V7_D_N05
Status	Controlled educational draft v0.1
Data boundary	Synthetic instructional data only

Central decision: Create a coherent WASH service picture by reconciling infrastructure, service delivery, household experience, quality, reliability, accessibility, and institutional responsibility.

Learning outcomes

Why this matters

Infrastructure presence can be mistaken for reliable service when water is unsafe, intermittent, unaffordable, inaccessible, or poorly maintained.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

Worked cross-sector example

A municipality compares network records, provider operations, and household evidence before declaring an area served.

Boundary: The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Preserve service-specific standards.
- 2.

- Add capital and operating constraints.
- 3.
- Protect underserved settlements.

Answer key

- 1.
- Keep component measures, definitions, responsible agencies, and service levels alongside any composite.
- 2.
- Model lifecycle cost, staffing, maintenance, capacity, lead time, and budget authority.
- 3.
- Include omitted settlements, suppress household identifiers, use participation and grievance channels, and prohibit punitive use.

Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.